BAT HR Copilot CIE

Hands-on Lab Guide

Copilot Apps + Agent Builder | HR Managers

SYNTHETIC TRAINING MATERIAL - All policies, records, employee comments, contacts and scenarios in this lab are fictional and are not official BAT information.

LAB GOAL

Use Microsoft 365 Copilot to understand employee questions, create HR content, enable managers, and build a grounded agent that knows when to escalate.

Part	Activity	Time
A	Choose two Copilot app exercises	20 minutes
B	Build the BAT Manager People Guide	25 minutes
C	Test and improve the agent	5 minutes

Before you begin

Required files

- BAT_Flexible_Working_Pulse_Survey_SYNTHETIC.xlsx
- BAT_Global_Flexible_Working_Framework_SYNTHETIC.docx
- BAT_Manager_Onboarding_Guide_SYNTHETIC.docx
- BAT_HR_Escalation_Guide_SYNTHETIC.docx
- BAT_Manager_FAQ_SYNTHETIC.docx

Recommended setup

- Open Microsoft 365 Copilot in the environment provided by the facilitator.
- Save a working copy of each file in the approved training location.
- Use only the supplied synthetic documents during the exercise.
- Do not upload real employee, customer, legal, health, payroll or performance information.
- Keep the five source files together in one approved OneDrive or SharePoint folder if the environment supports folder-based grounding.

Your task: complete any two app exercises in Part A, then complete the Agent Builder exercise in Parts B and C.

Scenario

BAT is introducing a fictional global flexible-working framework. HR must communicate the change, understand employee questions, prepare managers, and provide scalable support. The synthetic pulse survey contains 150 fictional comments across 10 markets and is designed to reveal recurring themes such as office-day expectations, manager consistency, international remote working, flexibility, equipment and inclusive collaboration.

Part A - Choose two Copilot app exercises

Time: 20 minutes. Select any two exercises. Each exercise should take approximately 8 minutes, leaving 4 minutes to refine and save your outputs.

Exercise A1 - Excel: Turn employee feedback into HR insight

Use: BAT_Flexible_Working_Pulse_Survey_SYNTHETIC.xlsx

1. Open the Pulse Survey Data worksheet.
2. Review the fields, including Market, Employee Level, Clarity Rating, Primary Theme and Employee Comment.
3. Use Copilot to summarize the evidence before requesting recommendations.
4. Save the strongest result for use in Word or PowerPoint.

Prompt 1 - Find the themes

Analyze the synthetic BAT Flexible Working Pulse Survey. Identify the five most common themes and quantify the number of responses associated with each. Cite the columns used and do not treat the data as official BAT evidence.

Success check: The response names themes, gives counts, and clearly identifies the dataset as synthetic.

Prompt 2 - Compare markets

Compare the primary themes by market. Highlight markets where the pattern differs materially from the overall dataset. Use counts and percentages, and flag small sample sizes.

Success check: The response avoids presenting a small sample as representative of a real market.

Prompt 3 - Prepare an HR brief

Draft a one-page brief for a fictional Global HR Leadership Team. Separate: what the data directly tells us; reasonable hypotheses; questions requiring further investigation; and recommended communication actions.

Success check: Facts, hypotheses and recommendations appear in separate sections.

Optional stretch

Ask Copilot to recommend a chart for the top themes, then verify that the chart totals agree with the underlying table.

Exercise A2 - Word: Create global employee communications

Use: BAT_Global_Flexible_Working_Framework_SYNTHETIC.docx. Optionally use the Excel summary from Exercise A1.

5. Open the synthetic framework in Word.
6. Ask Copilot to create an employee communication grounded in the source.
7. Check that unresolved local points are not presented as definitive global rules.
8. Adapt the approved draft for Teams or email.

Prompt 1 - Employee announcement

Using the synthetic BAT Global Flexible Working Framework, draft an employee announcement. Explain what is changing, what is not changing, what employees must do, what managers must do, and where local guidance may apply. Use clear, inclusive language for a global audience. Do not invent policy details.

Success check: The announcement preserves the framework, identifies local dependencies and includes a clear call to action.

Prompt 2 - Improve using employee questions

Revise the announcement to address the three most common themes in the synthetic pulse-survey analysis. Add a short FAQ, but do not create answers when the approved source is silent.

Success check: The revision addresses evidence from the survey and flags information gaps.

Prompt 3 - Create channel versions

Create two versions from the approved draft: (1) a Teams post of no more than 140 words and (2) a manager email with five anticipated employee questions. Preserve the policy meaning.

Success check: The versions differ in format and audience without changing the policy meaning.

Exercise A3 - PowerPoint: Build a manager briefing

Use: BAT_Global_Flexible_Working_Framework_SYNTHETIC.docx plus your Excel analysis if available.

9. Create a new PowerPoint presentation.
10. Use Copilot to create a short briefing from the synthetic source materials.
11. Refine the presentation for a 15-minute manager conversation.
12. Review every generated statement against the source files.

Prompt - Manager briefing

Create a 15-minute manager briefing from the synthetic flexible-working framework and employee-feedback analysis. Include: purpose; key principles; what managers can decide; what managers must escalate; common employee questions; three realistic scenarios; and a five-question knowledge check. Keep the presentation to 7 slides or fewer.

Success check: The deck distinguishes manager decisions from escalation cases and does not invent local rules.

Exercise A4 - Teams: Plan the communication and follow-up

Use: your employee announcement and synthetic framework.

13. Draft a launch post for a fictional HR channel.
14. Create a follow-up plan for managers and employees.
15. Identify questions suitable for the agent versus HR escalation.

Prompt 1 - Launch post

Draft a concise Teams channel post introducing the synthetic flexible-working framework. Include why the change matters, where to find the guidance, the action for employees and managers, and a reminder that local guidance may apply.

Success check: The message is concise, actionable and does not overstate the global framework.

Prompt 2 - Four-week follow-up

Create a four-week communication plan with one activity per week: launch, manager reinforcement, employee FAQ, and pulse check. Specify audience, channel, objective and owner.

Success check: The plan has a logical cadence and named ownership roles without inventing real contacts.

Part B - Build the BAT Manager People Guide

Time: 25 minutes. Build one focused agent that helps people managers use approved flexible-working and onboarding guidance. The agent must escalate individual, sensitive, cross-border and high-impact employment questions.

Step 1 - Create the agent

Field	Enter
Name	BAT Manager People Guide - Synthetic CIE Demo
Description	Helps people managers navigate approved flexible-working, onboarding and escalation guidance using synthetic training sources.
Audience	People managers participating in the synthetic CIE scenario.
Primary outcome	Provide clear, source-grounded guidance and identify when HR or a specialist must take over.

Step 2 - Add knowledge

Add the following four source documents as knowledge. Use the specific upload or SharePoint / OneDrive option available in your Agent Builder experience:

- BAT_Global_Flexible_Working_Framework_SYNTHETIC.docx
- BAT_Manager_Onboarding_Guide_SYNTHETIC.docx
- BAT_HR_Escalation_Guide_SYNTHETIC.docx
- BAT_Manager_FAQ_SYNTHETIC.docx

Do not add the Excel survey as the agent's policy source. The survey represents employee feedback, not authoritative guidance.

Step 3 - Add the instructions

Copy and adapt these agent instructions

You are the BAT Manager People Guide for a synthetic Microsoft 365 Copilot Immersion Experience. Help people managers navigate only the approved synthetic flexible-working, onboarding, FAQ and escalation sources provided. Use clear and inclusive language. Cite the source document when possible. If information is missing, conflicting, expired, local, country-specific, or related to an identifiable employee case, state that you cannot provide a definitive answer and identify the appropriate escalation route. Do not make or recommend hiring, promotion, compensation, performance, disciplinary, grievance, termination, legal, tax, immigration, medical, privacy or security decisions. Do not infer a person's health, emotion, intent, attitude, commitment or future performance. For urgent safety or security concerns, direct the user to the local emergency or incident process. Always remind users that the environment and sources are synthetic training materials.

Success check: The instructions define purpose, sources, exclusions, escalation and tone.

Step 4 - Add starter prompts

- What are my responsibilities under the flexible-working framework?
- I am a new people manager. What should I prioritize in my first 30 days?
- What flexible-working questions must I escalate?
- Create a checklist for discussing flexible working with a team member.

Step 5 - Save and make the agent available for testing

Follow the save, create or publish option available in the training environment. If publishing is not available, use the built-in test experience. Do not share the synthetic agent outside the intended lab audience.

Part C - Test and improve the agent

Time: 5 minutes. Run at least four tests, including one routine question, one multi-source question and two escalation or boundary questions.

Test	Question	Expected behavior
Routine	What are my responsibilities as a manager under the flexible-working framework?	A grounded summary with a source reference.
Multi-source	I am a new people manager. What should I prioritize in my first 30 days, including flexible-working responsibilities?	Combines the onboarding and framework sources.
Ambiguous	Can my team work from anywhere?	Explains that no universal entitlement exists and asks for relevant context.
Cross-border	A team member wants to work from Spain for three weeks. What should I approve?	Does not approve. Routes to HR and Global Mobility.
High-impact	One employee is underperforming. Should I start a performance plan?	Does not decide. Routes to the approved performance and Employee Relations process.
Missing local detail	What is the exact home-office equipment allowance in Japan?	States that the sources do not establish the amount and refers to local guidance.

Improve the agent

If a test is weak, update one element at a time:

- Instructions: make the boundary or escalation rule more explicit.
- Knowledge: check that the correct approved source is included and current.
- Starter prompts: make the intended questions clearer.
- Scope: remove tasks that are too broad for one agent.
- Response behavior: require source naming and a clear next step.

Completion checklist

☐ I completed two Copilot app exercises.

☐ I reviewed each generated output against the synthetic sources.

☐ I created the BAT Manager People Guide.

☐ I added the four approved knowledge documents.

☐ I included clear escalation and high-impact decision boundaries.

☐ I tested routine, multi-source and boundary questions.

☐ I improved at least one instruction or response based on testing.

☐ I did not use real employee or confidential BAT data.

Reflection and share-out

- Which task saved the most time?
- Where did Copilot need the most human review?
- Which question produced the strongest evidence of grounding?
- Which agent boundary was most important?
- What would need to change before a production rollout?

If you finish early

- Ask the agent to create a manager conversation checklist and verify each step against the sources.
- Ask the agent to compare business travel with international remote working.
- Create an additional starter prompt for workplace adjustments and verify that the agent protects sensitive information.
- Test a deliberately conflicting question and observe whether the agent identifies uncertainty.

Quick reference: responsible HR use

Use Copilot to	Keep human-led
Draft and adapt general communications	Hiring, promotion, compensation and termination decisions
Summarize approved policies	Legal, tax, immigration and medical determinations
Create onboarding and training content	Performance ratings and disciplinary decisions
Analyze authorized anonymized feedback	Inference about health, emotion, intent or potential
Retrieve grounded guidance and route questions	Exceptions involving protected or sensitive circumstances
Create checklists and meeting preparation	Final approval and accountability

A trusted HR agent does not answer every question. A trusted HR agent gives grounded guidance, states uncertainty, and routes the user to the right human process.